PRINTABLE ESCAPE GAME

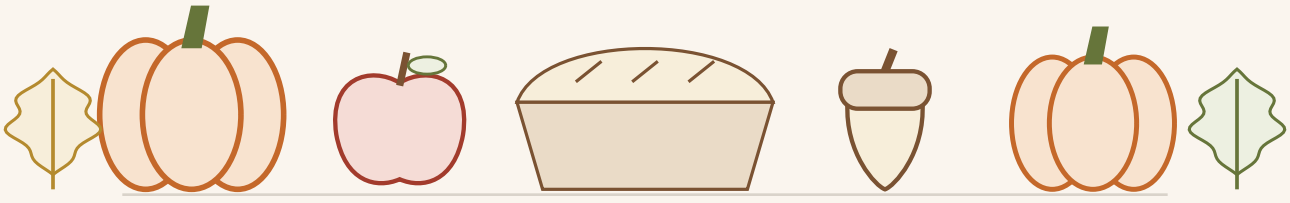
Thanksgiving Escape Room

The Pie Safe: one story, two levels. No phone or internet needed.

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

4 clues	8 hints	45 min	Host guide
each in 2 levels	cut-out hint cards	1 to 12 players	+ answer key



16 PAGES

PRINTABLE · INSTANT DOWNLOAD

READ THIS FIRST

Game Master Guide

Everything you need to run a 45-minute Thanksgiving escape game at home, at Grandma's or in a classroom.

HOW THE GAME WORKS

Grandma Hazel locked the four Thanksgiving pies in the old Pie Safe and mixed up the 4-digit code. Players solve 4 clues. Each clue gives one digit. The 4 digits, in order, open the safe.

Two levels, one story. Every clue comes in Level 1 (ages 6-9: counting, pictures, simple codes) and Level 2 (ages 10+: shift cipher, picture math, a maze, a logic grid). Both levels of a clue lead to the SAME digit, so brothers, sisters and cousins of different ages play together at the same table and can check each other.

Players: 1 to 12, in teams of 2 to 4. Time: about 45 minutes.

WHAT YOU NEED

- [ ] This PDF, printed (Letter or A4)
- [ ] Pencils and a few crayons
- [ ] Scissors and tape
- [ ] 5 envelopes per team (or folded paper)
- [ ] A timer or clock
- [ ] No phone, app, QR code or internet

Printing: ink-light pages (white paper, thin lines). Every puzzle works in black and white. On A4, choose "Fit to page".

Play it again: the other level makes a new game, so a team that played Level 1 this year can try Level 2 next time.

Big group? Print one set of clue sheets and lock tags per team and race to the Pie Safe.

SET UP IN 10 MINUTES

1. Print pages 3 to 14 and 16. Each team gets the clue sheets for its level (Level 1 or Level 2). Mixed-age team? Give it both.
2. Make one set of 5 envelopes per team. Cut out the lock tags (page 13, one page per team) and tape one on each envelope: Clue 1, Clue 2, Clue 3, Clue 4 and the Pie Safe.
3. Put each clue's sheets in its envelope, and the Pie Safe sheet (page 12) in the Clue 1 envelope so teams record digits as they go. The certificates (page 16) go in the Pie Safe envelope.
4. Cut out the hint cards (page 14) and keep them with the Answer Key (page 15). Players never see page 15.
5. Read the mission letter (page 3) out loud, start the 45-minute timer and hand out the Clue 1 envelope.
6. When a team finds a digit, they write it on the next envelope's lock tag and show you. Check it on the Answer Key. Right? They open that envelope. Not yet? They keep trying or ask for a hint.
7. Each team may ask for 3 hint cards. When the 4-digit code is right, read the victory note on page 15 and let the team open the Pie Safe envelope: their certificates are inside.

YOUR MISSION

The Pie Safe

Read this letter out loud to start the game.

Dear Thanksgiving Helpers,

This morning I baked four pies and locked them in the old Pie Safe so the dog could not reach them... and now I cannot remember the code! No code, no pie after dinner.

I am a careful cook, so I hid 4 clues around the kitchen. Each clue gives one digit of the code. Solve all 4, put the digits in order and the Pie Safe will open.

Please hurry. Dinner is on the table in 45 minutes!

With love, Grandma Hazel (head cook and pie keeper)

YOUR TEAM

Team name _____

Players _____

Level (circle): LEVEL 1 or LEVEL 2 or BOTH

Start time _____ Escape time _____

PIE SAFE CODE TRACKER: WRITE EACH DIGIT AS YOU FIND IT

CLUE 1	CLUE 2	CLUE 3	CLUE 4

CLUE 1

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

The Recipe Card Code

Grandma wrote the first digit on a recipe card in her secret number code. Each number stands for one letter.

THE CODE KEY: A IS 1, B IS 2, C IS 3...

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Warm up: decode this card first

WRITE A LETTER IN EACH BOX

16 9 5

Grandma's secret card

THE SECRET WORD IS A NUMBER

6 9 22 5

The first digit is ☐

CLUE 1

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Scrambled Recipe Note

Grandma hid the first digit in a shift code: every letter moved the same number of steps along the alphabet.

THE NOTE FOUND UNDER THE ROLLING PIN

X L I J M V W X

H M K M X M W J M Z I

Signed: L E D I P

How to crack it

1. The note is from Grandma Hazel, so the signature LEDIP must spell HAZEL. Count how many steps H moved to become L.

2. Every letter in the note moved by that same number. Move each letter BACK that many steps (after A, go round to Z).

3. Use the shift strip below: write the real letter under each code letter, then read the note.

SHIFT STRIP

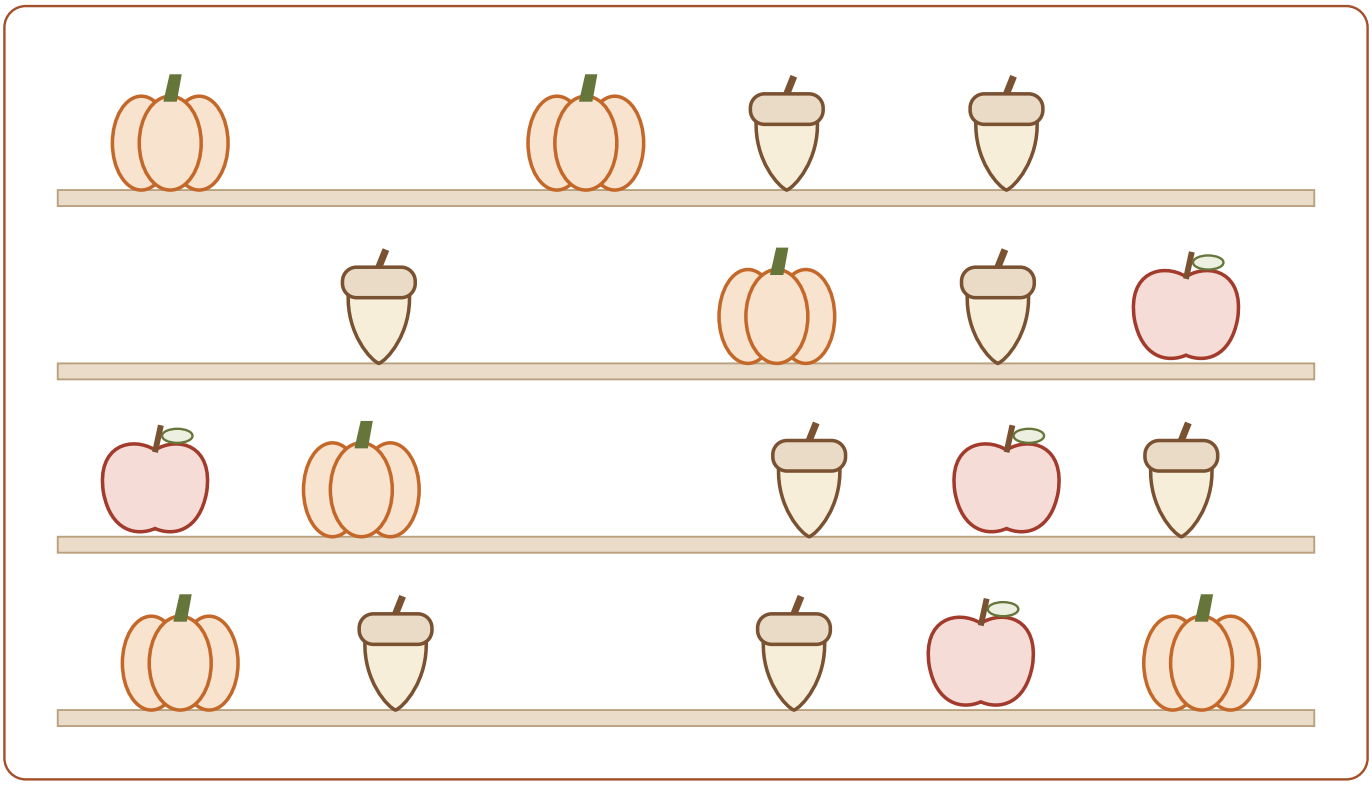
A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z

The first digit is ☐

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

Count the Pantry Shelf

Grandma says: count everything on my pantry shelf, then do my sum to find the second digit.



Pumpkins ☐

Apples ☐

Acorns ☐

Grandma's sum

☐ (pumpkins) + ☐ (apples) − ☐ (acorns) = ☐ (digit 2)

Tip: put a tiny dot on each picture as you count it so you never count one twice.

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

Harvest Picture Sums

Each picture stands for a different whole number. Work out all three, then solve Grandma's last line.

LINE 1



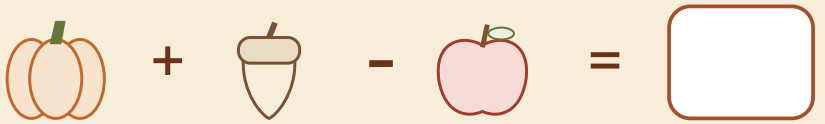
LINE 2



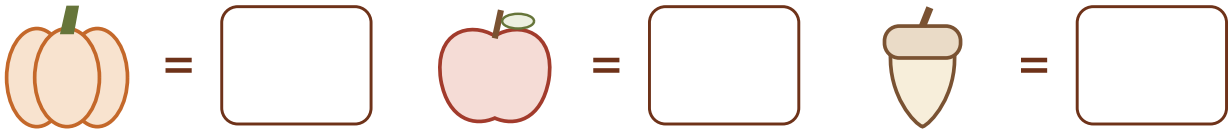
LINE 3



GRANDMA'S LAST LINE



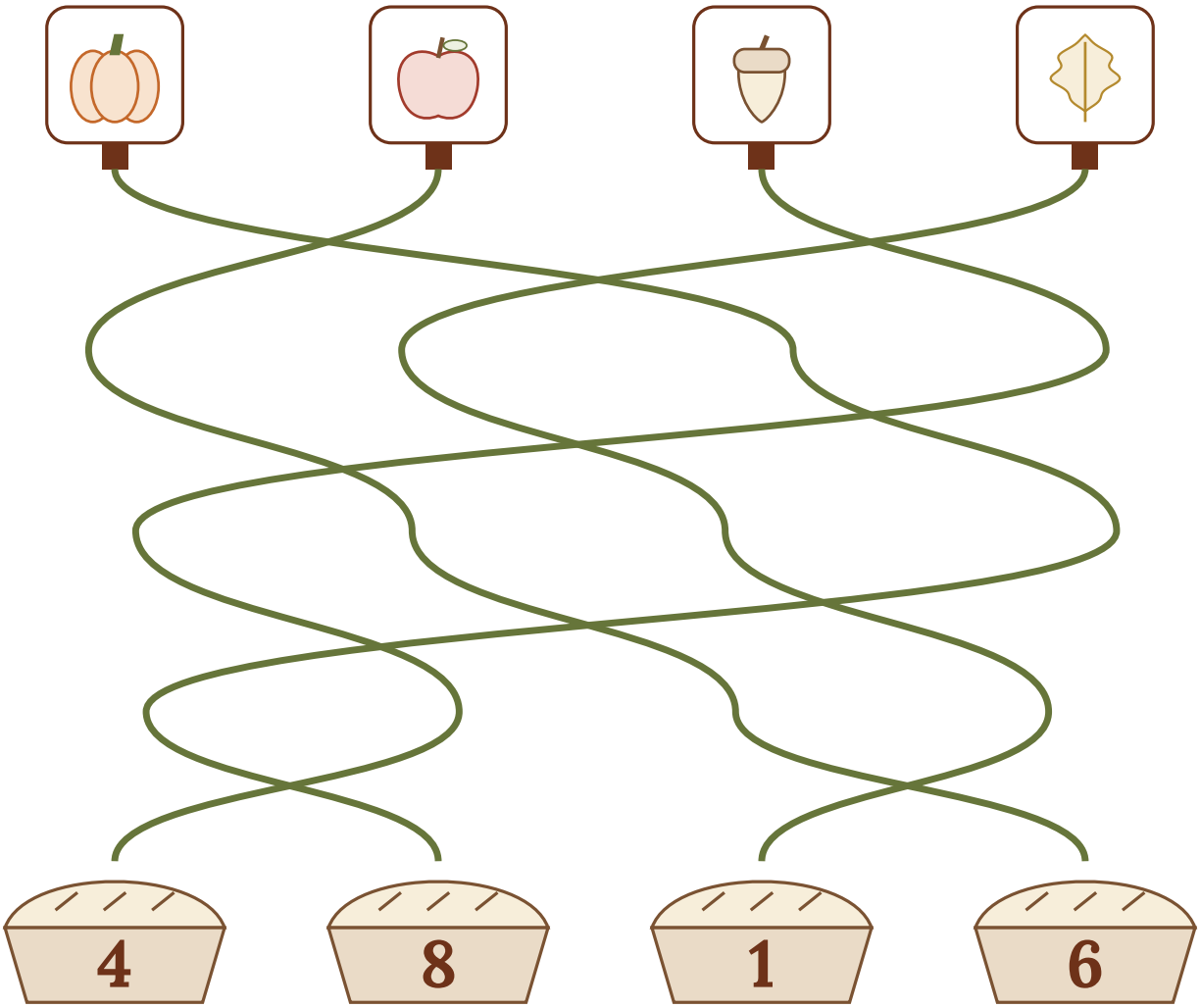
WRITE WHAT EACH PICTURE IS WORTH



LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

The Tangled Pumpkin Vines

The garden vines are all tangled up! Follow the vine from the PUMPKIN to find which pie it reaches.



Trace it with your finger or a crayon. The number on that pie is the third digit.

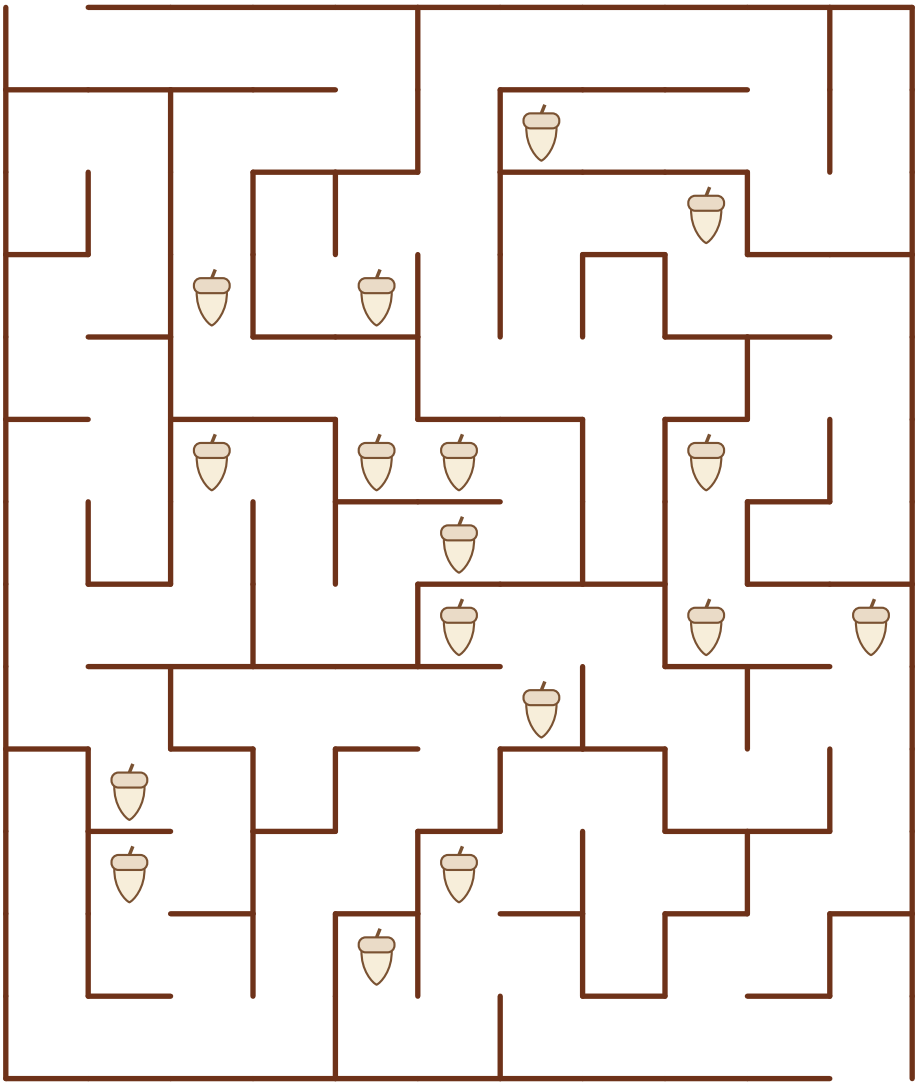
The third digit is ☐

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Acorn Maze

Find the only path from the Kitchen Door to the Pie Safe. Count the acorns ON your path; acorns in dead ends do not count.

START: KITCHEN DOOR



FINISH: THE PIE SAFE

The third digit is ☐

CLUE 4

LEVEL 1 · AGES 6-9

Leaf Sudoku

Fill the grid so every row, every column and every thick-lined box has 1, 2, 3 and 4 once each.

2	4		
1		2	
4			
	2		1

HOW TO PLAY

Start with a row or box that already has 3 numbers: the missing one is easy to spot. Write in pencil so you can rub out. When the grid is full, look at the square with the gold leaf: that number is the fourth digit.

The fourth digit is ☐

LEVEL 2 · AGES 10+

The Kids' Table Puzzle

Four cousins sit in chairs 1 to 4 at the kids' table. Each brought one dish. Use the clues to find which chair the pie is at.

GRANDMA'S CLUES

1. Theo sits in chair 1, and Theo did not bring the rolls.
2. Rosa brought the cranberry sauce.
3. Ada sits right between Theo and Milo.
4. The corn sits right next to the rolls.
5. Whoever brought the pie sits right next to Rosa.

	Chair 1	Chair 2	Chair 3	Chair 4	Corn	Cranberry	Pie	Rolls
Ada								
Milo								
Rosa								
Theo								
Corn								
Cranberry								
Pie								
Rolls								

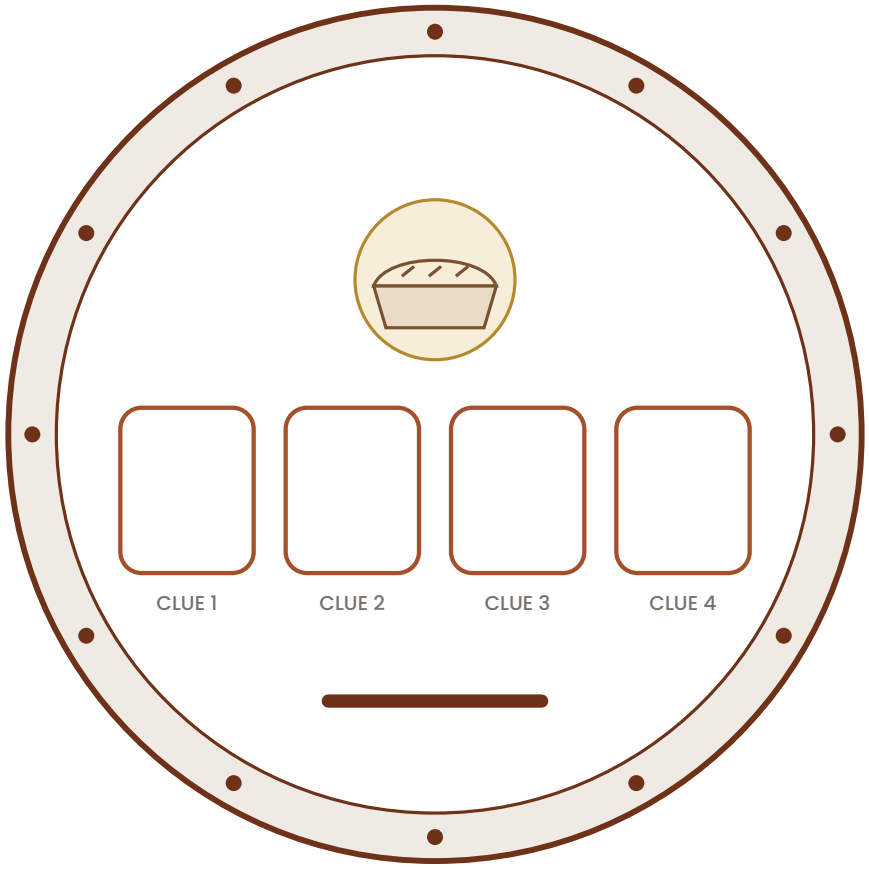
Mark X for "no" and a dot for "yes". Each row and column has one yes.

The pie is at chair ☐

THE FINAL LOCK

Open the Pie Safe

Write the 4 digits in order. Show the Game Master. If the code is right, the Pie Safe swings open!



WRONG CODE? CHECK THESE BEFORE YOU ASK FOR A HINT

- [ ] Are the digits in clue order: Clue 1, Clue 2, Clue 3, Clue 4?
- [ ] Mixed-age team? Both levels of a clue give the same digit. Compare your answers.
- [ ] Recount Clue 2 and retrace Clue 3 slowly: those are the easiest to slip on.
- [ ] Still stuck? Ask the Game Master for a hint card (3 per team).
- [ ] Code right? Open the Pie Safe envelope together: your Escape Expert certificates are inside. Write your escape time on page 3!

GAME MASTER: CUT OUT

Envelope Lock Tags

Cut out and tape one tag to each envelope. A team writes its digit on the tag and shows the Game Master to unlock it.

Clue 1

Open me first!

Recipe Card Code / Scrambled Recipe Note

Clue 2

Locked: needs the Clue 1 digit

Count the Pantry Shelf / Picture Sums

Clue 3

Locked: needs the Clue 2 digit

Tangled Pumpkin Vines / Acorn Maze

Clue 4

Locked: needs the Clue 3 digit

Leaf Sudoku / Kids' Table Puzzle

The Pie Safe

Locked: write the 4-digit code

Inside: Escape Expert certificates (page 16)

Game Master

Hint cards + answer key

Players: do not open

GAME MASTER ONLY

Hint Cards

Cut out, fold on the line so Hint 2 stays hidden, and hand over one card at a time (3 per team).

CLUE 1 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1 Find 16 in the code key. Which letter is above it?

fold here

HINT 2 The secret word is a number word with 4 letters.

CLUE 1 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1 H to L is 4 steps forward. So go 4 steps BACK for every letter.

fold here

HINT 2 X goes back to T, L to H, I to E: the first word is THE.

CLUE 2 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1 Count one kind of picture at a time, and dot each one.

fold here

HINT 2 There are more acorns than apples. Did you take the acorns away last?

CLUE 2 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1 Line 1 has three of the same picture. Divide 9 by 3.

fold here

HINT 2 Pumpkin first. Then line 2 gives the apple and line 3 the acorn.

CLUE 3 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1 Put a crayon on the pumpkin and never lift it off its vine.

fold here

HINT 2 At every crossing, stay on the same vine you came in on.

CLUE 3 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1 Mazes are easier from the end: try starting at the Pie Safe.

fold here

HINT 2 Shade dead ends as you find them. Only acorns on the open path count.

CLUE 4 · LEVEL 1

HINT 1 Row 2 already has 1 and 2. Which two numbers are missing?

fold here

HINT 2 The leaf square's row has a 4, and its column has a 2.

CLUE 4 · LEVEL 2

HINT 1 Clues 1 and 3 together tell you where Ada and Milo sit.

fold here

HINT 2 Rosa has the last chair. Which dishes can sit right next to her?

GAME MASTER ONLY

Answer Key

Game Master only: keep this page hidden from players.

CLUE	LEVEL 1 (AGES 6-9)	LEVEL 2 (AGES 10+)	DIGIT
1	16 9 5 = PIE; 6 9 22 5 = FIVE	Signature LEDIP = HAZEL (shift 4). Note reads THE FIRST DIGIT IS FIVE	5
2	6 pumpkins + 4 apples - 8 acorns = 2	Pumpkin 3, apple 5, acorn 4, so 3 + 4 - 5 = 2	2
3	The pumpkin vine ends at pie 8	The one path from door to Pie Safe passes 8 acorns (see map)	8
4	The gold leaf square is 3	Chair 1 Theo corn, 2 Ada rolls, 3 Milo pie, 4 Rosa cranberry	3

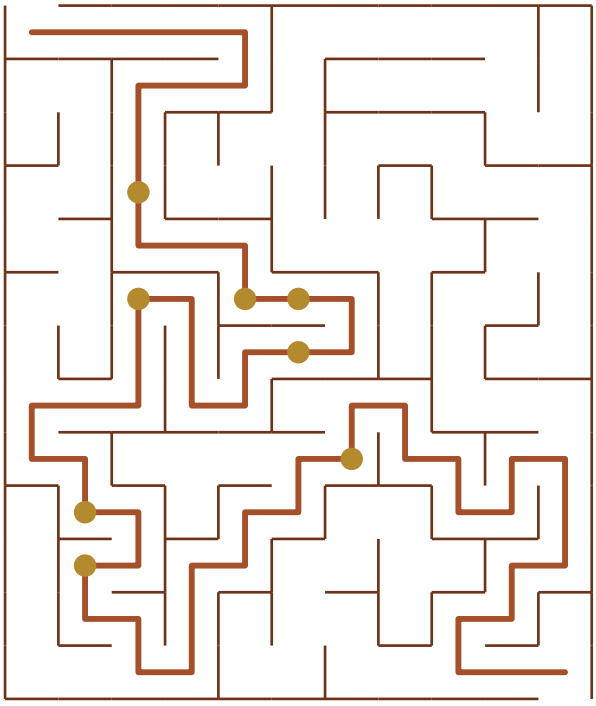
Safe code: 5 2 8 3

Both levels give the same 4 digits.

Sudoku solution

2	4	1	3
1	3	2	4
4	1	3	2
3	2	4	1

Maze solution path



Gold dots = the 8 acorns on the path. Acorns in dead ends do not count.

Read aloud when the safe opens:

"The Pie Safe door creaks open and there they are: four golden pies, still warm! Grandma Hazel hugs every one of you. Thanks to your team, there is pie after dinner. You are official Thanksgiving Escape Experts!"

TWO PER PAGE: PRINT ONE FOR EVERY PLAYER

Escape Expert Certificates

THE PIE SAFE

Certified Escape Expert

This certifies that

_____

opened the Pie Safe and saved Thanksgiving dessert.

LEVEL _____ ESCAPE TIME _____ DATE _____

Signed: Grandma Hazel, Keeper of the Pies

THE PIE SAFE

Certified Escape Expert

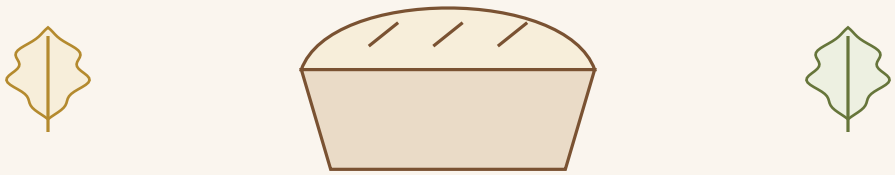
This certifies that

_____

opened the Pie Safe and saved Thanksgiving dessert.

LEVEL _____ ESCAPE TIME _____ DATE _____

Signed: Grandma Hazel, Keeper of the Pies



You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations